

Research services agreement

SYNTHETIC HOLDOUT FIXTURE - fictional terms for software evaluation only; not a real agreement or legal advice.

Study deliverables and acceptance

1. Study scope

Example Institute will perform the fictional materials study in the written protocol and deliver a methods memorandum, an interim dataset and a final report. Example Sponsor supplies the agreed sample inventory and access to the test site. The work is exploratory; no particular scientific result or regulatory approval is promised. Changes to the protocol require the written change process in clause 7.

2. General acceptance

Example Sponsor has ten business days after delivery to identify a material failure against the written acceptance criteria. Example Institute must correct an identified failure and resubmit the affected deliverable. Acceptance is deemed only if Example Sponsor neither identifies a material failure nor requests a reasonable clarification within that period. The final regulatory report has a narrow later amendment in Schedule R on page 7.

3. No invented accuracy warranty

The acceptance process tests whether the specified method and format were delivered. It does not warrant that a research hypothesis is true. A correction request must describe the failed criterion; a preference for a different conclusion is not itself a material failure.

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Ownership and permitted use

4. Background materials

Each party retains the methods, software and know-how it owned before this agreement. Example Institute grants Example Sponsor a perpetual nonexclusive licence to use embedded background tools only as needed to read and use the delivered report. No source-code transfer or general right to resell those tools is included.

5. Project work product

The final project report becomes Example Sponsor work product after payment of the applicable milestone. Example Institute may retain a non-public copy to meet its record-keeping duty and may use general techniques that do not disclose Example Sponsor's confidential information. Raw third-party licensed material remains subject to its separate source terms.

6. Pre-existing data

Example Sponsor's sample inventory remains its property. Example Institute may copy it only to perform the study and must not present it as a separately marketable dataset. A compiled research dataset produced under this agreement is governed by the data-use and return rules on page 6.

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Milestones, invoices and changes

7. Written scope changes

A change in study method, sample count, timetable or price requires a written change order approved by both parties before the extra work begins. Email approval from the named project contacts counts as writing if it identifies the changed item and price. A technician's field note alone does not authorize an extra charge.

8. Milestone invoices

Example Institute may invoice the agreed fee when each milestone deliverable is submitted. Each accepted milestone invoice is payable within thirty days of receipt. A disputed amount must be identified with reasons within ten business days; the undisputed amount remains payable on time. The final report fee does not become payable merely because a draft was circulated.

9. Delay caused by inputs

If Example Sponsor delivers samples or site access late, the parties will agree a reasonable timetable adjustment in writing. That adjustment does not automatically increase the price. A revised date is not evidence that a deliverable satisfied its acceptance criteria.

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Publication review

10. Draft review

A publication draft must be provided for review fifteen business days before submission, solely to remove confidential information or identify patentable material. Example Sponsor may request a postponement of no more than forty-five days for a good-faith patent filing. The review is not a veto over the scientific conclusion or a second acceptance period for the final report.

11. Authorship and disclosure

Each author is credited according to actual contribution. Neither party may disclose the other's confidential methods or unpublished sample inventory merely because a manuscript is being prepared. A permitted abstract can be shared after the review window and any agreed patent postponement.

12. Regulatory communication

A required communication to a regulator may proceed without the ordinary publication waiting period if law requires earlier disclosure. The disclosing party will give advance notice where legally permitted and limit the disclosure to what is required. This exception does not change the deliverable acceptance period.

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Confidentiality and term

13. Protected information

Non-public methods, sample identities, prices and study results marked confidential or reasonably understood to be confidential may be used only for this study. The confidentiality obligation survives three years after completion, except information that is public without breach or independently developed. A retained record copy must remain access-restricted during that period.

14. Required disclosure

If a party is legally compelled to disclose protected information, it may disclose the required portion and, where lawful, notify the other party in advance. The notice duty does not permit withholding information required by law. A recipient remains responsible for its own representatives' compliance.

15. End of study

The study term ends when the final report is accepted or the parties end it by written agreement. Rights accrued to payment and correction before that date continue. Completion does not change the ownership of background materials under clause 4.

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Dataset controls and return

16. Restricted research data

Research data may be used only to perform the agreed study and must not be used to train a general-purpose model. The research dataset must be kept separate from unrelated customer work and shared only with authorized study personnel. Example Institute may create aggregate statistics that cannot identify Example Sponsor's sample inventory.

17. Return and deletion

Within forty-five days after the study ends, Example Institute must return the research dataset to Example Sponsor and delete working copies, except a restricted archival copy may be kept for five years to satisfy an agreed audit duty. The archival copy may not be used for model training or a new commercial analysis. Example Institute will state what was returned and what lawful archival copy remains.

18. Data incident

Example Institute must promptly investigate unauthorized access to the research dataset and notify Example Sponsor without undue delay after confirmation. No fixed twenty-four-hour or thirty-six-hour notice deadline is promised by this clause. The data-processing addendum used by another fictional supplier is not incorporated into this research agreement.

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Schedule R - final-report amendment

R1. Conditional longer acceptance

Only the final regulatory report receives fifteen business days for acceptance where the validation appendix is delivered; all other deliverables retain ten business days. If the appendix is missing, the final report is not complete for delivery under clause 2 and the acceptance clock has not started. The longer period applies to final regulatory reports delivered on or after 1 August 2026, not earlier submissions.

R2. Correction and payment retained

A material failure identified during the applicable acceptance period must still be corrected and resubmitted under clause 2. The thirty-day invoice term in clause 8 continues after an accepted milestone invoice is received. Schedule R does not add a fifteen-day invoice deadline or make the publication review in clause 10 a deliverable acceptance process.

R3. Other terms

The publication draft remains subject to the separate fifteen-business-day review window in clause 10. That review may be postponed for patent filing within its own cap and does not alter R1. No other deliverable category or fee is amended by this Schedule.